

Counseling Management System

Complete Development Roadmap

Project Vision

Build a professional Counseling Management System that enables clients to learn about counseling services, book appointments, receive confirmations, and allows administrators to manage appointments, users, services, content and reports. The goal is to build a real-world portfolio project following professional software engineering practices.

Project Objectives

- Develop a modern, responsive website.
- Strengthen HTML, CSS and JavaScript skills by recreating the UI manually.
- Learn backend development with Django.
- Implement a relational database.
- Deploy a secure production-ready application.
- Build a project suitable for a professional portfolio.

Phase 1 – Frontend Development (HTML, CSS & JavaScript)

Goal

Recreate the approved UI/UX design into a fully responsive static website.

Objectives

- Build every page from scratch.
- Create reusable components.
- Ensure mobile responsiveness.
- Implement animations and interactions.

Pages Included

- Home
- About
- Services
- Book Appointment
- Counselor Profile
- Testimonials
- FAQ
- Contact
- Login
- Register
- Forgot Password
- Privacy Policy
- Terms & Conditions
- 404 Page

Expected Deliverable

A polished static website that is visually complete and ready for backend integration.

Phase 2 – Django Project Setup

Goal

Transform the static website into a Django application.

Objectives

- Create virtual environment.

- Install Django.
- Configure templates, static files and media.
- Create Django apps (accounts, appointments, dashboard, blog, contact, notifications).
- Integrate the HTML pages into Django templates.

Expected Deliverable

Every page loads through Django with a clean project structure.

Phase 3 – Database & Core Features

Goal

Turn the website into a functional web application.

Objectives

- Design database models.
- Implement authentication.
- Build appointment booking workflow.
- Create client and administrator dashboards.

Expected Deliverable

A fully functional counseling management system backed by a database.

Phase 4 – Advanced Features

Goal

Improve functionality and user experience.

Objectives

- Email confirmations and reminders.
- Appointment calendar.
- Availability management.
- Blog and announcements.
- Search functionality.
- Optional document uploads.

Expected Deliverable

A feature-rich application suitable for real users.

Phase 5 – Testing, Security & Deployment

Goal

Prepare the application for production.

Objectives

- Functional testing.
- Responsive testing.
- Security hardening.
- Deployment with PostgreSQL.
- Technical documentation.

Expected Deliverable

A secure, deployed production-ready application.

Version 2 – Future Enhancements

- Video counseling sessions
- Online payment integration
- AI-powered assistant
- SMS reminders
- Mobile application
- Multi-counselor support
- Reports and analytics
- Client progress tracking

Professional Development Workflow

- Requirements & Planning
- UI/UX Design
- Frontend Development
- Django Integration
- Database Implementation
- Feature Development
- Testing
- Security Hardening
- Deployment
- Maintenance & Continuous Improvement

Final Recommendation

Maintain a Software Requirements Specification (SRS) throughout the project. Document every feature, workflow, page, database model, business rule, and future enhancement. This document becomes the single source of truth for the entire project and makes future expansion much easier.